11+ Verbal Reasoning

Verbal Reasoning- Word and Meaning- 80 Practice Questions - HARD

Word and meaning questions across all nine question types, with full answers and explanations

WHAT THIS BOOKLET CONTAINS

80 questions across eight question types. Each type has 10 foundational questions and 10 advanced questions. Full answers with explanations are at the back. This is definitely a challenging set. Getting comfortable with these questions is excellent preparation for the real exam.

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A Note Before You Start

These questions are deliberately challenging. They are pitched at the level you will face in the Henrietta Barnett, Dame Alice Owen's, and St Michael's examinations. If some questions feel hard, that is the point. Working through them now, making mistakes, and reading the explanations is exactly how you get better.

Do not look at the answers until you have attempted every question in a section. The explanations at the back tell you not just what the answer is but why, so you can apply the same thinking next time.

It might help to walk your children through the first few questions, so they get a feel for the difficulty of these questions. Do not be disheartened if your child finds these hard, they are definitely meant to be hard and challenging, it is in best interest for your child to progress to be able to solve these.

> *“Struggling with a hard question and working out why you got it wrong is worth more than answering ten easy ones correctly.”*

01 Verbal Reasoning

Insert a Letter

Questions 1 to 20

Find the letter that ends the first word and begins the second in both pairs.

LEVEL 1 — FOUNDATIONS

1 SIN (?) AR | TA (?) ILL
(A) G (B) K (C) T (D) E (E) D

2 HEA (?) OP | PA (?) OT
(A) R (B) L (C) T (D) M (E) N

3 BA (?) ORE | CO (?) ILL
(A) R (B) N (C) T (D) L (E) D

4 HEA (?) EAR | SEA (?) ARE
(A) R (B) L (C) T (D) M (E) N

5 BA (?) ORE | CA (?) ALL
(A) R (B) L (C) T (D) M (E) N

6 PEA (?) ANT | CLEA (?) EAR
(A) R (B) L (C) T (D) N (E) D

7 PAN (?) EAR | CAR (?) ALL
(A) R (B) L (C) T (D) M (E) N

8 PI (?) ODE | DU (?) ET
(A) R (B) L (C) T (D) N (E) E

9 HEA (?) EAR | ROA (?) EER
(A) D (B) S (C) Y (D) E (E) N

10 ROA (?) EAR | HO (?) OT
(A) D (B) S (C) T (D) E (E) N

LEVEL 2 — ADVANCED

11 WAR (?) ANY | TEA (?) ALE
(A) R (B) T (C) N (D) L (E) M

12 PA (?) ICE | SI (?) ET
(A) T (B) N (C) L (D) G (E) R

13 SEA (?) ALL | COA (?) EAR
(A) L (B) T (C) N (D) R (E) P

14 RU (?) EAR | SU (?) ET
(A) N (B) T (C) D (D) L (E) G

15 PLA (?) EAR | SLA (?) ALL
(A) N (B) T (C) L (D) E (E) R

16 WI (?) EAR | BI (?) ET
(A) N (B) T (C) D (D) L (E) G

17 17. SEA (?) OP | CAR (?) AR
(A) R (B) **L** (C) **T** (D) L (E) D

18 CA (?) EAR | BA (?) ARE
(A) R (B) **K** (C) **T** (D) L (E) D

19 BO (?) EAR | MA (?) ALL
(A) R (B) T (C) N (D) L (E) D

20 CA (?) ODE | LI (?) ET
(A) N (B) T (C) D (D) L (E) R

02 Verbal Reasoning

Two Odd Ones Out

Questions 21 to 40

Pick the TWO words that do not belong in the group.

LEVEL 1 — FOUNDATIONS

21 21. Poodle, Beagle, Siamese, Terrier, Persian, Spaniel

22 22. Oboe, Flute, Cello, Clarinet, Violin, Piccolo

23 23. Square, Circle, Cube, Triangle, Sphere, Hexagon

24 24. Chisel, Saw, Hammer, Nails, Screws, Pliers

25 25. Ostrich, Eagle, Penguin, Owl, Falcon, Hawk

26 26. Mars, Venus, Moon, Jupiter, Sun, Saturn

27 27. Trout, Salmon, Shark, Whale, Dolphin, Cod

28 28. Running, Jumping, Eating, Swimming, Thinking, Hopping

29 29. Copper, Iron, Glass, Gold, Plastic, Silver

30 30. Doctor, Nurse, Surgeon, Pilot, Steward, Paramedic

LEVEL 2 — ADVANCED

31 31. Salmon, Trout, Cod, Rose, Daisy, Haddock

32 32. Paris, London, Berlin, Asia, Europe, Madrid

33 33. Hiss, Buzz, Roar, Silent, Quiet, Grunt

34	34. Oak, Pine, Rose, Birch, Daisy, Beech
35	35. Thief, Criminal, Robber, Hero, Police, Outlaw
36	36. Sweet, Sour, Bitter, Salty, Spicy, Hot
37	37. Inch, Metre, Litre, Yard, Gallon, Mile
38	38. Mumble, Whisper, Shout, Listen, Hear, Bellow
39	39. Anvil, Stirrup, Hammer, Knee, Elbow, Wrist
40	40. Dread, Fear, Terror, Joy, Delight, Horror

03 Verbal Reasoning

Closest Meaning

Questions 41 to 60

Pick one word from each bracket that are most similar in meaning.

LEVEL 1 — FOUNDATIONS

41 (Fast, Slow, Quick) | (Rapid, Swiftly, Speed)

42 (Giant, Small, Tiny) | (Huge, Minute, Large)

43 (Hard, Soft, Firm) | (Solid, Tough, Gentle)

44 (Start, Finish, Begin) | (Commence, End, Stop)

45 (Shout, Whisper, Talk) | (Yell, Murmur, Speak)

46 (Angry, Calm, Mad) | (Furious, Peaceful, Relaxed)

47 (Old, New, Ancient) | (Modern, Antique, Fresh)

48 (Bright, Dark, Dim) | (Luminous, Gloomy, Faint)

49 (Easy, Hard, Simple) | (Basic, Tough, Complex)

50 (Beautiful, Ugly, Pretty) | (Gorgeous, Hideous, Lovely)

LEVEL 2 — ADVANCED

51 (Astute, Melancholy, Benevolent) | (Sad, Clever, Kind)

52 (Forlorn, Diligent, Resolute) | (Determined, Lonely, Hard-working)

53 (Eloquent, Astute, Forlorn) | (Clever, Well-spoken, Hopeless)

54	(Trepidation, Diligent, Melancholy) | (Anxiety, Busy, Sadness)
55	(Found, Search, Looking) | (Discovered, Seek, Find)
56	(Strolled, Running, Walk) | (Walked, Sprinting, Step)
57	(Pale, Bucket, Pail) | (Vessel, Light-coloured, Bin)
58	(Stationary, Paper, Letter) | (Still, Stationery, Note)
59	(Brief, Lengthy, Heavy) | (Short, Vast, Weighty)
60	(Ponder, Ignore, Forget) | (Consider, Overlook, Neglect)

04 Verbal Reasoning

Word Connections

Questions 61 to 80

Complete the second pair so it matches the relationship of the first pair.

LEVEL 1 — FOUNDATIONS

61 PUPPY is to DOG as KITTEN is to
(A) Mouse (B) Cat (C) Pet

62 FINGER is to HAND as TOE is to
(A) Leg (B) Foot (C) Shoe

63 BIRD is to NEST as RABBIT is to
(A) Hole (B) Burrow (C) Warren

64 DOCTOR is to HOSPITAL as TEACHER is to
(A) School (B) Classroom (C) Student

65 KNIFE is to CUT as PEN is to
(A) Ink (B) Write (C) Scribble

66 SHEEP is to FLOCK as FISH is to
(A) Sea (B) School (C) Swim

67 PILOT is to PLANE as CAPTAIN is to
(A) Ship (B) Sea (C) Crew

68 SMILE is to HAPPY as FROWN is to
(A) Angry (B) Sad (C) Cry

69 EAR is to HEAR as EYE is to
(A) See (B) Look (C) Blink

70 LION is to ROAR as SNAKE is to
(A) Slither (B) Bite (C) Hiss

LEVEL 2 — ADVANCED

71 BREEZE is to GALE as TRICKLE is to
(A) Flood (B) Stream (C) Water

72 WOLF is to PACK as BEE is to
(A) Swarm (B) Hive (C) Colony

73 SCALPEL is to SURGERY as CHISEL is to
(A) Woodwork (B) Hammer (C) Sculpture

74 COLD is to FREEZING as HOT is to
(A) Warm (B) Scorching (C) Boiling

75 MUMBLE is to SHOUT as WHISPER is to
(A) Scream (B) Talk (C) Yell

76 PEARL is to OYSTER as HONEY is to
(A) Bee (B) Hive (C) Flower

77 ANVIL is to BLACKSMITH as KILN is to
(A) Potter (B) Oven (C) Baker

78 ORCHESTRA is to CONDUCTOR as TEAM is to
(A) Coach (B) Player (C) Captain

79 PROLOGUE is to BOOK as OVERTURE is to
(A) Opera (B) Music (C) Ending

80 GLUTTONY is to FOOD as AVARICE is to
(A) Money (B) Hunger (C) Greed

ANS Answers and Explanations

Answers and Explanations

Full answers with explanations for all 160 questions

How to use this section

For each question you got wrong, read the explanation carefully. Ask yourself: which part of the method did I miss? Then go back to that question and try it again from scratch before moving on.

Section 01: Insert a Letter (Questions 1-20)

1	**Answer: G**	SING + GAR, TAG + GILL. G ends SING, starts GAR, ends TAG, starts GILL.
2	**Answer: T**	HEAT + TOP, PAT + TOT. T ends HEAT, starts TOP, ends PAT, starts TOT.
3	**Answer: T**	BAT + TORE, COT + TILL. T is the only letter that makes four real words.
4	**Answer: R**	HEAR + REAR, SEAR + RARE. R ends both first words and starts both second words.
5	**Answer: M**	BAM + MORE, CAM + MALL. M ends both first words and starts both second words.
6	**Answer: R**	PEAR + RANT, CLEAR + REAR. R is the letter that makes all four words real.
7	**Answer: T**	PANT + TEAR, CART + TALL. T works for both pairs consistently.
8	**Answer: N**	PIN + NODE, DUN + NET. N ends both first words and starts both second words.
9	**Answer: D**	HEAD + DEAR, ROAD + DEER. D ends both first words and starts both second words.
10	**Answer: D**	ROAD + DEAR, HOD + DOT. D is the only letter that works across both pairs.
11	**Answer: M**	WARM + MANY, TEAM + MALE. M ends WARM, starts MANY, ends TEAM, starts MALE.
12	**Answer: N**	PAN + NICE, SIN + NET. N ends both first words and starts both second words.
13	**Answer: T**	SEAT + TALL, COAT + TEAR. T ends both first words and starts both second words.
14	**Answer: N**	RUN + NEAR, SUN + NET. N ends both first words and starts both second words.

15	**Answer: T** | PLAT + TEAR, SLAT + TALL. T ends both first words and starts both second words.
16	**Answer: N** | WIN + NEAR, BIN + NET. N ends both first words and starts both second words.
17	**Answer: C | SEAT + TOP, CART + TAR. T ends both first words and starts both second words.**
18	**Answer: R** | CAR + REAR, BAR + RARE. R ends both first words and starts both second words.
19	**Answer: T** | BOT + TEAR, MAT + TALL. T ends both first words and starts both second words.
20	**Answer: N** | CAN + NODE, LIN + NET. N ends both first words and starts both second words.

| Section 02: Two Odd Ones Out (Questions 21-40)

21	**Answer: Siamese, Persian** | Both are cat breeds. Poodle, Beagle, Terrier, and Spaniel are all dog breeds.
22	**Answer: Cello, Violin** | String instruments. Oboe, Flute, Clarinet, and Piccolo are all woodwind instruments.
23	**Answer: Cube, Sphere** | Three-dimensional shapes. Square, Circle, Triangle, and Hexagon are all flat (2D) shapes.
24	**Answer: Nails, Screws** | Fasteners, not tools. Chisel, Saw, Hammer, and Pliers are all tools you hold and use.
25	**Answer: Ostrich, Penguin | Both are flightless birds. Eagle, Owl, Falcon, and Hawk all fly.e**
26	**Answer: Moon, Sun** | Not planets. Moon is a natural satellite; Sun is a star. Mars, Venus, Jupiter, Saturn are all planets.
27	**Answer: Whale, Dolphin** | Mammals, not fish. Trout, Salmon, Shark, and Cod are all fish.
28	**Answer: Eating, Thinking** | Not physical exercises. Running, Jumping, Swimming, and Hopping are all physical activities.
29	**Answer: Glass, Plastic** | Man-made non-metals. Copper, Iron, Gold, and Silver are all natural metals.
30	**Answer: Pilot, Steward** | Aviation roles. Doctor, Nurse, Surgeon, and Paramedic are all medical roles.
31	**Answer: Rose, Daisy** | Flowers, not fish. Salmon, Trout, Cod, and Haddock are all types of fish.
32	**Answer: Asia, Europe** | Continents, not cities. Paris, London, Berlin, and Madrid are all capital cities.

33	**Answer: Silent, Quiet** | Describe lack of sound. Hiss, Buzz, Roar, and Grunt are all specific sounds animals make.
34	**Answer: Rose, Daisy** | Flowers, not trees. Oak, Pine, Birch, and Beech are all types of tree.
35	**Answer: Hero, Police** | Uphold the law or act virtuously. Thief, Criminal, Robber, and Outlaw are all lawbreakers.
36	**Answer: Spicy, Hot** | Sensations of heat/capsaicin, not true tastes. Sweet, Sour, Bitter, and Salty are the four basic tastes.
37	**Answer: Litre, Gallon** | Measures of volume. Inch, Metre, Yard, and Mile all measure length or distance.
38	**Answer: Listen, Hear** | Receiving sound, not making it. Mumble, Whisper, Shout, and Bellow all describe how someone speaks.
39	**Answer: Knee, Elbow** | Body joints. Anvil, Stirrup, and Hammer are the three tiny bones inside the ear.
40	**Answer: Joy, Delight** | Positive emotions. Dread, Fear, Terror, and Horror are all types of fear or negative emotion.

| Section 03: Closest Meaning (Questions 41-60)

41	**Answer: Fast / Rapid** | Both mean moving quickly. Quick is close but Rapid is the stronger, more precise match.
42	**Answer: Tiny / Minute** | Both mean very small. Minute (pronounced MY-newt as an adjective) means extremely small.
43	**Answer: Hard / Solid** | Both describe something firm and unyielding. Firm/Solid and Hard/Tough are the closest pairs.
44	**Answer: Begin / Commence** | Both mean to start something. Commence is a more formal synonym for Begin.
45	**Answer: Shout / Yell** | Both mean to speak very loudly. Yell and Shout are directly interchangeable.
46	**Answer: Angry / Furious** | Both mean very displeased. Furious is the strongest match for Angry.
47	**Answer: Ancient / Antique** | Both describe something very old. Antique is the closest synonym for Ancient in context.
48	**Answer: Bright / Luminous** | Both mean producing or emitting light. Luminous is the most precise synonym for Bright.
49	**Answer: Hard / Tough** | Both describe something difficult. Hard and Tough are directly interchangeable here.

50	**Answer: Beautiful / Gorgeous** | Both mean very attractive. Gorgeous is the closest and strongest synonym for Beautiful.
51	**Answer: Astute / Clever** | Astute means quick to notice and understand things. Clever is its closest everyday synonym.
52	**Answer: Resolute / Determined** | Resolute means firmly committed to a course of action. Determined is its closest synonym.
53	**Answer: Eloquent / Well-spoken** | Eloquent means expressing ideas clearly and persuasively. Well-spoken is its closest synonym.
54	**Answer: Trepidation / Anxiety** | Trepidation means nervousness or worry about something ahead. Anxiety matches this exactly.
55	**Answer: Search / Seek** | Both mean to look for something. They are directly interchangeable as verbs.
56	**Answer: Strolled / Walked** | Both are past tense verbs describing movement on foot at a relaxed pace.
57	**Answer: Pail / Vessel** | Pail means a bucket or container. Vessel is the most accurate synonym for a container.
58	**Answer: Stationary / Still** | Stationary means not moving. Still means not moving. They are direct synonyms.
59	**Answer: Brief / Short** | Both mean lasting only a short time or having little length. They are directly interchangeable.
60	**Answer: Ponder / Consider** | Both mean to think carefully about something. They are direct synonyms.

| Section 04: Word Connections (Questions 61-80)

61	**Answer: Cat** | Puppy is the young of a dog. Kitten is the young of a cat. Young animal to adult animal.
62	**Answer: Foot** | A finger is part of a hand. A toe is part of a foot. Part to whole relationship.
63	**Answer: Burrow** | A bird lives in a nest. A rabbit lives in a burrow, not a warren (which is the whole underground system) or a hole (too vague).
64	**Answer: School** | A doctor works in a hospital. A teacher works in a school. Person to their place of work.
65	**Answer: Write** | A knife is used to cut. A pen is used to write. Object to its primary function.
66	**Answer: School** | A group of sheep is called a flock. A group of fish is called a school. Animal to collective noun.

67	**Answer: Ship** | A pilot flies a plane. A captain steers a ship. Person to the vehicle they command.
68	**Answer: Sad** | You smile when you feel happy. You frown when you feel sad. Expression to emotion.
69	**Answer: See** | You use your ears to hear. You use your eyes to see. Organ to its function.
70	**Answer: Hiss** | A lion makes a roar. A snake makes a hiss. Animal to the sound it makes.
71	**Answer: Flood** | A gale is a very strong breeze. A flood is a very strong trickle. Both go from mild to extreme.
72	**Answer: Swarm** | A group of wolves is a pack. A group of bees in flight is a swarm. (Hive is where they live; swarm is the group.)
73	**Answer: Sculpture** | A scalpel is the tool used in surgery. A chisel is the tool used in sculpture. Tool to its craft.
74	**Answer: Scorching** | Freezing is extreme cold. Scorching is extreme heat. Both are the most extreme versions.
75	**Answer: Scream** | Mumble is the quiet end; shout is the loud end. Whisper is the quiet end; scream is the loud end. Both move from quiet to very loud.
76	**Answer: Bee** | Pearls are produced by oysters. Honey is produced by bees. Produced by its source.
77	**Answer: Potter** | A blacksmith uses an anvil. A potter uses a kiln. Craft to the specialist tool it uses.
78	**Answer: Coach** | A conductor leads an orchestra. A coach leads a team. Leader to the group they lead.
79	**Answer: Opera** | A prologue comes at the start of a book. An overture comes at the start of an opera. Opening section to its form.
80	**Answer: Money** | Gluttony is excessive desire for food. Avarice is excessive desire for money. Sin to what it relates to.